

Database Locks Runbook

This runbook explains how to investigate database locks, blocked queries, active sessions, blocking processes, long-running transactions, and migration-related lock issues.

Common Symptoms

Application requests are slow, API calls time out, database CPU rises, checkout or login requests wait for database queries, and monitoring reports `database.production.locks.high`.

First Checks

Check active sessions. Identify blocked queries. Identify the blocking process. Check whether a migration or long-running transaction started recently. Review database connection pool usage.

Safe Actions

Do not kill production sessions without DBA approval unless the incident commander approves emergency action. Prefer identifying the owner and impact first.

Escalation

Escalate to the DBA team if blocking queries affect production users, if the blocking process is unknown, or if a migration is causing lock contention.